MAHADEVAN VARADHAN

Senior Manager · Lead Data Engineer · Senior Data Architect · Senior BI Developer · AI/ML Engineer

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Online resume (full interactive version): https://mahadevanvaradhan.github.io/

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Program Delivery & Data Analytics Leader with 20+ years in software across media, education, and enterprise platforms. Proven track record leading AI, Data, and Analytics transformations, managing large-scale product delivery engagements, and ensuring delivery excellence across global teams. An Agile leader and hands-on people manager, skilled in aligning data strategy, AI enablement, and delivery execution with business outcomes—measurable ROI, high utilization, and strong profit margins. Flexible with domestic and international travel for client engagement.

Core Expertise: Data & Analytics Strategy · Data Visualization · Data Architecture · Data Modelling · AI/GenAI Enablement · Program & Delivery Leadership · Agile Transformation · Stakeholder & Resource Management · ISO/Compliance · Business Intelligence & Insights

CERTIFICATIONS

- DP-600: Microsoft Certified Fabric Analytics Engineer Associate
- DP-700: Microsoft Certified Fabric Data Engineer Associate
- Generative AI for NLP — Great Learning
- Data Science & Machine Learning — Great Learning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Data & Analytics

CYGNVS | Jan 2026 – Present

Leading the data and BI team to build real-time data engineering on AWS and GCP, delivering decision-making insights with Looker ML and Looker Data Studio.

- Replaced legacy datalake with a multi-dimensional data warehouse and datamarts using medallion architecture.
- Upgraded reporting with real-time metrics to help clients prevent damage from risks and cybersecurity incidents.
- Integrated HubSpot data into BigQuery to help Sales upgrade clients to premium features.

Director of Data & Engineering

Talentship.io | Jan 2022 – Jan 2026

AI & Analytics Enablement

- Built and scaled AI/GenAI capabilities (LLM faculty & customer support bots), reducing resolution time by 65%.
- Designed personalization and anomaly detection frameworks driving proactive insights and engagement.
- Defined enterprise AI strategy with executives, resulting in 5+ reusable frameworks across analytics & ML projects.

Program & Delivery Leadership

- Directed multi-domain data platforms achieving 99.9% availability and consistent client satisfaction.
- Applied Agile delivery pipelines, improving productivity by 30% and ensuring on-time delivery.
- Led ISO 9001/27001/27701 certifications, strengthening compliance governance.

Business Analytics, Infrastructure & Governance

- Built executive dashboards consolidating Salesforce, OneStream, and internal data into a Fabric Lakehouse.
- Implemented enterprise pipelines (Airflow, DBT, Fabric, Glue), reducing latency by 40% across 10+ domains.
- Mentored 100+ engineers and analysts; drove self-service BI and churn/engagement models.

Director of Data & Engineering

Learnship.com | Jan 2019 – Jan 2022

- Managed large-scale AWS serverless migration, reducing infra costs by 45% while improving availability.
- Delivered global data warehouse post-acquisition, reducing analyst hours 3× annually.
- Launched AI-powered Newsfeed with personalized learning content, increasing engagement by 30%.
- Led CDP integration of Learnship and GlobalEnglish; established GDPR/ISO-aligned governance.
- Led modernization workshops/hackathons, upskilling 50+ engineers in serverless and AI practices.

Senior Data Architect / Project Manager

News Technology Services (News Corp) | May 2016 – Jan 2019

- Designed enterprise CDP enabling segmentation that drove 20% uplift in targeted campaigns.
- Built real-time editorial dashboard (BigQuery + NLP APIs), replacing third-party tools and saving $1.5M annually.
- Migrated pipelines to Airflow, cutting latency 50% for 5+ global newsrooms.
- Built churn prediction model (+8% retention, +12% LTV); managed 40-member cross-functional data team.

Technology Specialist – Data

Pearson Business English | 2012 – 2016

- Re-architected enterprise data warehouse supporting 1M+ learners, improving reporting performance by 35%.
- Delivered dashboards tracking adoption and learner success, influencing product strategy.

Earlier roles: BI Analyst — EC Group Soft (2011–2012) | BI Consultant — Congruent Info-Tech (2007–2011)

KEY PROJECTS

AO Lakehouse & Reporting Talentship · Fabric / Power BI Lakehouse and Power BI visualization reports on Microsoft Fabric for analytics and decision support.	**Octonomy Knowledge Store** Octonomy · LLM / Embeddings Embedding-based knowledge retrieval with LLMs for real-time customer intelligence.
Unified HR Azure Databricks · dbt / Medallion Multiple Azure Databricks pipelines loading Bronze, Silver, and Gold for HR—HRIS, recruitment, right-to-work, and employee service data on serverless compute with Unity Catalog governance.	**Analytics Lakehouse** Octonomy · Lakehouse Lakehouse architecture for analytics and visualization across product and customer domains.
AI-Powered Newsfeed Learnship · NLP / AI Personalized learning content with NLP analytics driving double-digit engagement growth.	**Editorial Intelligence Dashboard** News Corp · BigQuery / NLP Real-time editorial dashboard with BigQuery and NLP APIs—saved $1.5M annually.
Sales Data Warehouse CYGNVS · BigQuery / HubSpot Medallion-architecture warehouse with HubSpot integration for premium Sales upgrades.	**Customer Data Platform** News Corp · CDP Enterprise CDP enabling audience segmentation with 20% uplift in targeted campaigns.

KEY SKILLS

Strategy & Leadership: Data & Analytics Strategy · Program & Delivery Leadership · Agile Transformation · Stakeholder Management · Team Mentorship · CxO Partnership

Data & Platforms: Data Architecture · Data Modelling · Lakehouse Design · ETL/ELT · Data Governance · ISO/GDPR Compliance

AI & Analytics: AI/GenAI Enablement · LLM Applications · NLP · Predictive Analytics · Anomaly Detection · Recommendation Systems

Business Intelligence: Data Visualization · Executive Dashboards · Self-Service BI · KPI Design · Churn & Retention · Business Insights

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Defined and executed AI/Analytics strategies at Director level across 3 organizations.
- Spearheaded multiple ISO certifications, unlocking enterprise contract eligibility.
- Migrated 80% of systems to serverless cloud, reducing costs 45%.
- Built AI-powered solutions that improved customer satisfaction, engagement, and retention.
- Led global teams of 100+, modernizing platforms and enabling a data-driven culture.
- Delivered editorial intelligence platform at News Corp saving $1.5M annually.

TECH STACK

Cloud & Databases: Azure · AWS · GCP · BigQuery · Redshift · Synapse · PostgreSQL · MySQL · MSSQL · DynamoDB · SAP HANA · Fabric · Athena · ClickHouse

ETL & Data Tools: Airflow · AWS Glue · DBT · Dataform · Data Factory · MWAA · Talend · Cloud Composer · Databricks · Step Functions · SSIS · Dataflow

Visualization: Power BI · Tableau · Looker ML · Looker Data Studio · SSRS · Jupyter Notebook

AI & ML: Cursor · OpenAI · Google Gemini · Grok · Mistral · Anthropic Claude · LangChain · LlamaIndex · Python · RAG · MCP · Streamlit · NLP · NLTK · Pandas · PySpark · SciKit · NumPy

STRATEGIC LEADERSHIP DOMAINS

Program Delivery: Large engagement delivery, Agile leadership, product integration, delivery excellence, risk management, profitability oversight.

Data, Science & AI: ML, GenAI, LLMs, NLP, recommendation systems, predictive analytics, anomaly detection, customer segmentation.

Business Analytics: KPI design, churn prediction, CLV, conversion & retention, self-service BI, executive dashboards.

Team & Governance: Global leadership (100+), hiring & scaling, CxO partnerships; lakehouse platforms; ISO, GDPR & SOC2 compliance.

AWARDS & EDUCATION

Awards: Best Manager — News UK (2018) · Employee of the Year — Pearson (2014) · Star Performer — Global English (2013)

Education: Master of Science — University of Madras, Chennai

Interactive resume: https://mahadevanvaradhan.github.io/ · GitLab: gitlab.com/users/mahadevanvaradhan/projects · Website: cloudmerge.org · Blog: mahadevanrv.blogspot.com